

Edit Videos with AI

The Claude Code + Remotion Setup Guide

Setup time: 10 minutes • Cost: free (with Claude subscription) • Skill required: none

Why this guide exists

Video editing is the last creative skill AI couldn't fully touch. That just changed. Claude Code paired with Remotion lets you build, edit, and ship full videos using nothing but plain English. This is the setup that makes it work.

What you'll build

Once setup is done, you can prompt Claude to:

- Generate a full video from a single text description
- Add subtitles, split screens, and transitions automatically
- Build product demos by pasting a URL
- Create animated explainers on any topic
- Render data visualizations from a CSV file
- Export everything as MP4

The shift

You describe the outcome. Claude builds the video. No timeline editing. No keyframes. No drag and drop.

Before you start

You'll need:

- A computer with a terminal (Mac, Windows, or Linux)
- A paid Claude account (Pro, Max, Team, or Enterprise)
- Node.js 18 or higher installed

To check Node.js, run this in your terminal:

```
node --version
```

If you see v18.0.0 or higher, you're good. If not, install Node.js from nodejs.org first.

STEP 1

Install Claude Code

Claude Code is Anthropic's coding agent that lives inside your terminal. It runs commands, installs tools, and executes multi-step workflows.

On Mac or Linux

Open your terminal and paste:

```
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.sh | bash
```

On Windows (PowerShell)

Open PowerShell and paste:

```
irm https://claude.ai/install.ps1 | iex
```

Verify the install

```
claude --version
```

You should see a version number. If it says "command not found," close your terminal and open a new window.

Log in

```
claude
```

Pick "Claude account with subscription" and complete the browser authentication. Done.

STEP 2

Add the Remotion video skill

Remotion is the open source video framework. Their pre-built skill teaches Claude exactly how to write video code, animation patterns, and best practices.

Run this in your terminal:

```
npx skills add remotion-dev/skills
```

Install takes about a minute. That's it.

Optional: start a new project

If you want a clean Remotion project to work in, run `npx create-video@latest`. Pick the "Hello World" template, then `cd` into your new project folder.

STEP 3

Build your first video

Inside your project folder, run:

```
claude
```

This opens Claude Code. Now paste a prompt like this:

Use the Remotion best practices skill. Create a 30-second educational explainer video (1080x1920, 30fps) that teaches "How AI Agents Work". Keep all text within the safe zone (150px from top, 170px from bottom, 60px side margins). Headlines 56px or larger. Body 36px or larger. Research the topic first, then write a 5-scene script before writing any code.

Claude will:

1. Research the topic
2. Write the script
3. Design the scenes
4. Animate everything
5. Open a live preview at localhost:3003

Preview in your browser. To export the final MP4:

Render the video to MP4

Ready-to-use prompt templates

Copy, swap your topic in, and paste into Claude Code.

Education explainer

```
Use the Remotion best practices skill. Create an educational explainer video (1080x1920, 30fps, 30 seconds) that teaches [YOUR TOPIC]. Safe zone: 150px from top, 170px from bottom, 60px side margins. Minimum fonts: headlines 56px, body 36px. Research the topic and write a 5-scene script first.
```

Product demo from a URL

```
Use the Remotion best practices skill. Create a 25-second product demo video (1080x1920, 30fps) for the product at [YOUR PRODUCT URL]. Scrape branding and screenshots from the URL. Safe zone: 150px from top, 170px from bottom. Minimum fonts: headlines 56px, body 36px.
```

Data visualization from CSV

```
Use the Remotion best practices skill. Take the CSV in public/[YOUR FILE].csv and create an animated data visualization video (1080x1920, 30fps, 25 seconds). Pick the best chart type. Safe zone: 150px from top, 170px from bottom. Headlines 56px+.
```

5 tips that 10x your output

1. Always start the prompt with: "Use the Remotion best practices skill."

This single line triggers the right behavior every time.

2. Be specific about format.

1080x1920 for vertical (Reels, Shorts, TikTok). 1920x1080 for horizontal (YouTube, web).

3. Define safe zones.

Mobile platforms cover the top and bottom of your video with UI. Always tell Claude to keep important content within the safe zone.

4. Iterate in conversation.

If the first output isn't right, just say "make the bars wider" or "slow down the typing speed" or "change the accent to orange." Claude reruns instantly.

5. Save your reusable prompts.

Once you find a workflow that works for your style, save it as a template. You'll reuse it across every video.

Troubleshooting

"claude command not found"

Close your terminal completely and open a new window. The PATH variable refreshes only on restart. On Windows, manually add this to PATH if still failing:

```
%USERPROFILE%\local\bin
```

Remotion skill didn't install

Re-run the install. Make sure Node.js 18+ is set up:

```
npx skills add remotion-dev/skills
```

Output doesn't look right

Be more specific in your prompt. Don't say "make it look professional." Say "use a dark background, white headlines in 64px Arial bold, accent color blue."

Video preview won't open

Check that localhost:3003 isn't blocked. You can also ask Claude to render directly to MP4 instead of previewing.

Why this matters

Video editing used to require:

- Heavy desktop software like Premiere Pro or Final Cut
- Hours of manual cutting and timeline work
- A trained editor or weeks of self-learning
- Subscriptions costing hundreds per year

Now it requires:

- One terminal
- One conversation
- One clear instruction

The takeaway

The skill that used to take years to develop now takes a clear instruction. Everything runs locally on your computer. The only cost is your Claude subscription.

Start simple.

Take one short topic. Ask Claude to create a 15-second explainer with subtitles. Ship it. Then scale up.

You're now using one of the most underrated AI workflows of 2026.